



FATIMID
GOLD COIN

▲ FATIMID CALIPHATE

In the 10th century, the Fatimids, who claimed to be descendants of the Prophet Muhammad's daughter, rose to power. A rival dynasty to the Abbasids, they ruled across North Africa, Egypt, and most of Syria from 909 to 1171. The Fatimids grew rich through trade in the Mediterranean and Red seas.



Seljuk warriors were skilled riders and fought on horseback.

◀ SELJUK EMPIRE

The Seljuk Empire was founded in the 11th century CE and lasted until the 14th century CE. The Seljuks established a vast empire that at its peak stretched from modern-day Turkey to Pakistan. In 1073, they captured the city of Jerusalem. This led to Christian armies mounting the First Crusade in 1096 in order to wrestle the city back from Muslim control.

SALAH AL-DIN

Salah al-din (reigned 1174–1193) overthrew the Fatimids and founded the Ayyubid Dynasty. He became the first sultan of Egypt and Syria, and then conquered neighboring Muslim states. He is best known for his role in the Third Crusade when he recaptured Jerusalem from Christian armies in 1187.



The walls of the shrine are decorated with tiles.

